

CD-WRITERS

MSI	Plextor	Samsung	Sony
CR52-M	W5224TA	SW 252	CRX220E1
52X/ 32X/ 52X	52X/ 24X/ 52X	52X/ 24X/ 52X	52X/ 24X/ 52X
E-IDE	E-IDE	E-IDE	E-IDE
2	2	8	2
4	4	3	4
Play, Next Track, Stop, Eject	Single eject button	Single eject button	Single eject button
2	Single, Multi-colour	Single, Multi-colour	Single, Multi-colour
✓	✓	✓	✓
✓	✗	✗	✗
4	4	3	4
✓	✓	✗	✗
✗	✗	✓	✓
✓	✗	✓	✗
✗	✗ (Quick installation guide)	On CD-RW	✗
✗	✗	✗	✓
✗	✗	✓	✓
✓	✓	✓	✓
31.88	8	31.42	31.51
78	126	91	86
6	97	9	14
1	17	1	17
0	4.16	1.39	4.24
8.96	0.01	4.07	5.43
0	10	10	10
3.3	3.5	3.5	3.5
902	1100	787	933
208	161	254	204
12	9	7	9
6	24	6	6
9	17	6	5
163	172	158	155
164	183	207	157
125	139	126	129
448	477	457	491
149	159	152	144
223	238	279	294
218	231	284	296
1, Carry in	1, Carry in	15 months from the date of manufacture	1, Carry in
6.46	4.88	7.25	6.08
71.72	65.68	67.80	71.12
25.22	10.09	21.44	14.99
8	8	8	8
Cyberstar	Zeta Technologies	Samsung Electronics India Information & Telecommunication Ltd	Rashi Peripherals
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3,100	6,990 + taxes	3,500	5,150

its nearest competitors Liteon and Sony, who finished with 52 and 53 seconds each. This bodes well for the Samsung drive, as faster data transfer rates is good for users who are always copying data to and from the hard drive.

The Nero CD Speed tests also saw some very tough competition. All the drives gave a DAE quality of 10 with an accurate stream, except BenQ, which logged in a DAE quality score of 5 without an accurate stream. The LG 52X had the fastest disc recognition time, while the Samsung came in last. The LG drive stood first in the CPU utilisation tests, needing only 5 per cent CPU power at an 8X read speed, while the Samsung logged in the highest with 84 per cent—not good news if you intend to multi-task. All the drives successfully backed up the copy-protected data discs—except the BenQ drive, which failed both the copy-protection tests.

And the winner is... CD-R/RW drives

The Krypton 52X/32X/52X was the unanimous winner in terms of performance. It beat all the big brands and came out tops in the performance tests, earning our Best Performance award. Although the manufacturers still need to take care of the packaging and at least provide a CD-R with the drive.

The BenQ CRW5224W

was the winner of the

Best Value award. The packaging of this drive is among the best and it

The only thing the Krypton lacks is packaging frills

also packs in a 2 MB buffer, costs less than Rs 3,000 and a 1 year warranty.



The BenQ has all it takes to please your wallet

Combination Drives

The Sony CRX 300A drive

showed extremely good performance results, and took our

Sony is the best performer, speed limit not withstanding



The Liteon LTC-4161H is a valued performer

Best Performance award. The build quality of this drive is quite good and it has a 2 MB buffer which takes care of the buffer under-run risks. If only the speed limit feature could be turned off somehow!

The Liteon LTC-4161H takes the best value award. It is the lowest priced drive among all the entrants, and also does a pretty good job in all fields.

BHASKAR BANIK

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